VOTE

for the honorary mayor of the house, the street or the whole town

pet's name here

(species: cat · dog · goat · rhino · other _____)

paste your pet's best photo here
(the haughtier the better)





Running on a platform of

- ☐ Naps for all
- ☐ Eating things
- ☐ Water in a wine glass
- ☐ A tiny hat for every citizen
- ☐ No promises, so none broken
- ☐ Zero scandals (so far)

ENDORSED BY REAL OFFICIALS



Cacareco
100,000 votes



Tama
stationmaster



Stubbs
20 years



Bosco
beat 2 humans



Lincoln
goat, mayor

Paid for by the treat budget. Honorary office, no legal powers, like the twelve on the back.

Sources The twelve real officials, with their sources, are on page 2. Poster slogans are jokes, not claims.

12 real animal officials

The honest bit: almost every one is honorary, a fundraiser or a stunt, usually in a place with no town government. The joke is that some still did better than the humans. No animal with real legal powers turned up.

WRITE-IN



Cacareco

rhinoceros, São Paulo, 1959

Zoo rhino drew about 100,000 write-in votes (around 15%) for city council, reportedly the most of any candidate. Officials annulled them and re-ran it.

APPOINTED



Tama

calico cat, Kishi Station, Japan

Stationmaster from 5 Jan 2007, in a tiny hat. One economist estimated about 1.1 billion yen in local impact (the scope is debated). Died in 2015, aged 16.

HONORARY



Stubbs

cat, Talkeetna, Alaska

Mayor from about 1997 until he died in 2017, aged 20. Office: a general store. Survived a dog attack in 2013. Drank water from a wine glass.

HONORARY



Bosco

Labrador mix, Sunol, California

Beat two humans to become honorary mayor in 1981 and served until 1994. Memorialised with a beer tap.

HONORARY



Lincoln

goat, Fair Haven, Vermont

Elected 5 March 2019 as a playground fundraiser, with a one-year term. Main policy: eating things.

HONORARY



Murfee

therapy dog, Fair Haven, Vermont

Succeeded Lincoln as mayor and won re-election in 2021.

HONORARY



Wilbur Beast

French bulldog, Rabbit Hash, Kentucky

Won in 2020 with 13,143 of 22,985 votes, the most ever. Anyone in the world can vote for $1. The mayoral race began in 1998 as a fundraiser.

HONORARY



Brynneth Pawltro

pit bull, Rabbit Hash, Kentucky

Mayor from 2016, the incumbent Wilbur followed. Every elected mayor of Rabbit Hash has been a dog.

HONORARY



Clay Henry

goat, Lajitas, Texas

Began in 1986 as a mock election against a wooden statue and a dog named Buster. Famously liked beer.

HONORARY



Mayor Max

dog, Idyllwild, California

Elected in a 2012 shelter fundraiser where humans were not allowed to run. Later Maxes kept the title in the family, with a vice mayor.

APPOINTED



Larry

cat, Cabinet Office, UK

Chief Mouser since 15 February 2011, the first with the official title. He has outlasted several prime ministers.

APPOINTED



Palmerston

cat, Foreign Office, UK

The Foreign Office's cat, hired in 2016. Not elected either, but the paperwork says cat.



The numbers worth stealing for your campaign: Cacareco, about 100,000 votes. Wilbur, 13,143 votes. Tama, about a billion yen. Stubbs, 20 years in office. Your pet's platform: nothing, and it will keep that promise.

Sources hoaxes.org; Wikipedia: Cacareco · Japan Times 2008; CNN 2008 (Tama) · CBS News 2017 (Stubbs); Atlas Obscura · NBC News, Inquirer 2020 (Rabbit Hash) · VTDigger 2019 (Lincoln) · ABC News; VinePair (Clay Henry) · Wikipedia: Larry (cat)